Defense Minister Gallant has been dismissed.

A tsunami of protests in the middle of the night. Hundreds of thousands on the streets. The police cannot handle the situation. Fires lit on the Ayalon Highway. Incredible. Heads of towns and localities will start hunger strikes from tomorrow. The trade unions (the Histadrut) are joining the protests. From tomorrow, the universities are on strike. Israel's consul general in New York has resigned.

Netanyahu convened a cabinet meeting in the middle of the night. A senior member of the Likud (Edelstein?) declared that Netanyahu and Levin are destroying the Likud. The ultra-Orthodox are in favor of stopping the overhaul, but they will accept what Netanyahu decides … Deri declared the same. Levin is against stopping. I am proud of Israel and Israelis. Hopefully, Netanyahu's end is approaching.

This time, Lapid and Gantz issued a declaration in common. They call on members of the Likud to refuse to replace Gallant (the two candidates are Dichter and Nir Barkat): "Whoever accepts to replace him brings shame upon itself." It's hard to see how anybody would be stupid enough to accept the job. Of course, Netanyahu may decide to take the ministry upon himself.

As I was looking at the huge demonstrations on the evening news, it occurred to me that even such angry protests, which in many other countries would have turned violent, remain "bon enfant" in Israel. Jews are used to violence against them, but not to intra-Jewish violence. I said some weeks ago that the demonstrators were too polite: it is true, but inherent to Israeli demonstrations and, I admit it, luckily so. Even the deep social resentments underlying the crisis do not change such "atavistic" norms.

This may be contradicted by the fact that Rabin was murdered and that individual violence is rife. I think that it remains true about mass demonstrations, but let us see how it goes.